# KENTARO NAKAMURA

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## EDUCATION

**Harvard University** Sep.2023 – Present
Ph.D. | *Public Policy* (Politics and Institution Track) Cambridge, USA
- Affiliation: Institute of Quantitative Social Science (IQSS)

**University of Chicago** Sep.2021 – Jun.2023
Master of Science | *Statistics* Chicago, USA

**Waseda University** Apr.2017 – Sep.2021
Bachelor of Arts | *Major: Political Science, Minor: Law, Certificate: Data Science* Tokyo, Japan
- Best Paper Award (Excellent work at the Category of Mathematical and Statistical Measurement)

**George Washington University** Aug.2019 – May.2020
Exchange Program Washington D.C., USA

## RESEARCH INTEREST

Causal Inference with Machine Learning, Text Analysis, Artificial Intelligence, Political Communication

## PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

**Leveraging Generative Artificial Intelligence for Causal Inference with Unstructured Data**
*Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, with Kosuke Imai [URL]
- Proposed a new framework to use the internal representations of deep generative models for statistical inference

**Causal Inference with Generative Artificial Intelligence: Application to Texts as Treatments**
*Journal of the American Statistical Association*, with Kosuke Imai [URL]
- Developed new experimental designs to use texts created by deep generative model as a treatment

**Understanding the Impact of Military Service on Support for Insurrection in the United States**
*Journal of Conflict Resolution*, with Robert Pape, Keven Ruby, and Kyle Larson [URL]
- Analyzed why and how civilians with prior military experiences are prone to support political violence.

**Balancing Opportunities and Incentives: How Rising China's Mediated Public Diplomacy Changes under Crisis**
*International Journal of Communication* [URL]
- Estimated the strategic shift of the rising China's public diplomacy under crisis by machine learning

## SELECTED WORKING PAPERS

**Surrogate Representation Inference for Text and Image Annotations**
*Revise and Resubmit at Annals of Applied Statistics* [URL]
- Proposed a framework to improve efficiency with noisy and partially observed annotations
- Best poster award at the 2025 Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology.

**Observational Equivalence of LLM and Human Annotation**
*Revise and Resubmit at Political Analysis*, with Jing Ling Tan and George Yean [URL]
- Evaluated the quality of LLM annotations compared to human annotations.

**GenAI Powered Dynamic Causal Inference with Unstructured Data**
*Under Review*, with Kosuke Imai [URL]
- Proposed a framework to intervene the unstructured data at more granular level (e.g., sentences).

**Where's the Evidence that Respondents Understand Your Survey Questions?**
*Under Review*, with Musashi Hinck, Gary King, and Brandon Stewart [URL]
- Proposed a framework and methodology to assess survey question understanding.

**Causal Inference with Video Features as Treatments**
*Working Paper*, with Adam Breuer, Michael H. Crespin, Bryce J. Dietrich, Kosuke Imai [URL]
- Proposed a framework for causal inference with video features as treatments.

**A General Statistical Framework for Attention and Manipulation Checks**
*Working Paper*, with Kosuke Imai [URL]
- Proposed a framework for attention and manipulation checks with measurement error.

## Invitaed Talks / Presentations

**Frontier in Political Methodology**, Washington University in St. Louis (2026) [URL]

**Stanford University**, Guest Speaker for POLISCI 450D (2026)

**Causal Inference Showcase**, Harvard University (2026). [URL]

**Nospare** (Webinar for public audiences) (2025) [URL]

## Software

**Debriefly [URL]**
Survey Software for Automated Cognitive Debriefing

**gpi-pack [URL]**
Python module for Generative-AI Powered Inference.

## Research Experience

**Research Assistant for Prof. Gary King** May.2024 – Present
Harvard University Cambridge, USA
- Worked on the project of the automated cognitive debriefing (co-author)

**Research Assistant for Prof. Matthew Baum** Nov.2023 – Present
Shorenstein Center, Harvard Kennedy School Cambridge, USA

**Data and Causal Inference Analyst** Sep.2022 – Aug.2023
Chicago Projects on Security and Threats (CPOST), University of Chicago Chicago, USA
- Designed experiments, discussed identification strategies, and implemented causal mediation analysis

**Research Assistant for Prof. Shuhei Kurizaki** May.2020 – Sep.2021
Waseda University Tokyo, Japan
- Conducted the qualitative research on the foreign takeover in Europe (Co-Author since September 2020)

## Teaching Experience

**Teaching Fellow: GOV2003 (Causal Inference with Applications)** Fall 2026
Harvard University Cambridge, USA
- Offered by Prof. Kosuke Imai

**Teaching Fellow: GOV2003 (Statistical Models for Quantitative Social Science)** Spring 2026
Harvard University Cambridge, USA
- Offered by Prof. Kosuke Imai (Evaluation: 5.0 / 5.0) [Evaluation]

**Teaching Fellow: GOV2002 (Causal Inference with Applications)** Fall 2025
Harvard University Cambridge, USA
- Offered by Prof. Kosuke Imai (Evaluation: 4.67 / 5.0) [Evaluation]

**Teaching Assistant at the Center for Data Science** Sep.2020 – Mar.2021
Waseda University Tokyo, Japan
- Checked class materials and answered the questions about Statistics and Machine Learning

## Honors and Awards

**Center for American Political Studies (CAPS) Seed Grant** Apr.2026
Research Grant for Dissertation Research (USD1,000)

**Society of Political Methodology Best Poster Award** Jul.2025
Best Method Poster presented by graduate students at PolMeth2025 (Emory) [News]

**The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Research Grant** Apr.2025
Research Grant for Dissertation Research (USD2,000)

**The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Research Grant** Apr.2025
Research Grant for the joint project with Jing Ling Tan and George Yang (USD2,000)

**Harvard Kennedy School Travel Grant** Jan.2025
Travel Grant for attending JSQPS2025 Winter Meeting (USD1000)

**The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Travel Grant** Jul.2024
Travel Grant for attending PolMeth2024 (USD500)

**Japanese Student Service Organization Scholarship** Sep.2023 - Aug.2026
Merit-based scholarship. Partial tuition coverage (JPY 3 million yen) and monthly stipends.

**Graduate Council Research & Personal Development Fund, University of Chicago** Jan. 2023
Travel Grant for attending SPSA2023 (USD600)

**Tuition Fellowship, University of Chicago** Sep. 2021 - Jun. 2023
Equivalent to 25 percent of my approved tuition. Increased to 30% from 2nd year

**Statistics Consulting Cup Awards** Dec.2021
Best Prize in the Consulting Program at the Department of Statistics. [News]

**NSK Ltd. Scholarship** Sep.2021 – Jun.2023
Scholarship provided only for top four students in Japan. JPY13,600,000 ≈ USD100,000

**Japanese Student Service Organization Scholarship** Mar.2021
Declined to accept NSK Scholarship. Merit-based scholarship.

**Best Paper Award (Category of Mathematical and Statistical Measurement)** Feb.2021
Thesis Competition of the Waseda Association for Political Science and Economics [News]

**Japanese Student Service Organization Scholarship** Aug.2019 – May.2020
Merit based scholarship to support exchange program. JPY900,000. ≈ USD7,000

## Academic Services / Discussant Roles

**Discussant**: SPSA (2023), APSA (2025)
**Reviewer**: Political Analysis (3), International Studies Quarterly, Journal of Applied Econometrics
**Others**: Coordinator of Applied Statistics Workshop, Harvard University (2025-2026)

## Skills

**Languages**: Japanese (Native), English (Fluent), Spanish (B1; Intermediate)
**Programming**: (Proficient) Python(3.X), R, C++ (Rcpp), LaTeX, ArcGIS, STATA, HTML / (Experience) C, SQL

## References

Available upon request

*Last updated on November 9, 2026*